PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Office of General Counsel
501 North Dixon Street / Portland, OR 97227
Telephone: (503) 916-2000
Mailing Address: P. O. Box 3107 / 97208-3107

STAFF REPORT

Date: July 2, 2025

To: Board of Education

CC: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

Sharon Toncray, General Counsel

From: Liz Large, Contracted Senior Legal Counsel

Subject: Lobbying Registration Policy

BACKGROUND & ANALYSIS

In January 2025, the Policy Committee initiated the drafting and consideration of a proposed Lobbying Registration policy, recognizing that the Board and District staff regularly engage with potential vendors or other interested parties, who seek policy, contract, or expenditure decisions and may seek to influence those decisions. Over several meetings, the Policy Committee revised draft language to require an individual or entity to register on the District's website if it is engaging with staff or Board members more than five hours per quarter with the intent to influence a policy or expenditure in which the individual/entity has an economic interest of $100,000 or more.

Excluded from the registration requirement are certain contracts subject to the public procurement process (*e.g.*, Requests for Proposals, Invitations to Bid), collective bargaining agreements, general marketing communications, performance of existing District contracts, or advocacy when there is no direct financial interest.

The Policy Committee's stated purpose of the registration is to create transparency about who is seeking to obtain certain policy, contract, or expenditure decisions. At this time, the policy requires disclosure, but does not contain an enforcement mechanism. This decision was made in recognition of the staff constraints the District is experiencing.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

Ethics & Conflict of Interest Policy: 5.10.066-P

FISCAL IMPACT

Staff time to create a website and other communications regarding registration obligation, staff oversight of the process. No new FTE are expected to be hired.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT (IF APPLICABLE)

Draft policy was on Policy Committee agenda January 13, February 26, April 3, May 12, and June 23 for public meeting and comment.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

As soon as practicable after formal adoption, likely within 90 days.